

Maria Kunilovskaya

Curriculum Vitae

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Research profile

Computational approaches to political communication and social-group representation; multilingual parliamentary and social-media text analysis; natural language processing and large-scale corpus methods; LLM-based annotation and evaluation; quantitative empirical methods; translation and interpreting studies.

Current interdisciplinary research: political discourse and social-group appeals (RISS); computational analysis of propaganda and information manipulation; language variation and information-theoretic approaches to translation.

Professional career

- 04/2026 - present **Postdoc Researcher**, Natural Language Learning & Generation Lab, University of Technology Nuremberg
- NLP lead for the interdisciplinary RISS project on political discourse analysis
 - designing and supervising large-scale human annotation workflows
 - developing LLM-based methods for social media and parliamentary text analysis
 - collaborating with social scientists on empirical analyses and publications
- 12/2022 - present **Postdoc Researcher**, Language Science and Technology Department, Saarland University
- research under B7 project: Translation as Rational Communication
 - collaborations within the Research Center on Information Density and Linguistic Encoding (SFB-1102), inc. joint publications with B6 (Josef van Genabith), C4 (Tania Avgustinova)
 - teaching and supervising in the BA/MA and B/M.Sc. linguistics degree programmes
 - maintaining language resources, setting up annotation experiments
- 04/2022 - 05/2022 **Lecturer**, University of Malaga (Spain)
- European Masters in Technology for Translation and Interpreting (EMTTI)
- 02/2022 - 12/2023 **Research Assistant**, RIILP, University of Wolverhampton (UK)
- research on simplification in translation and interpreting
 - teaching and supervising MA theses
- 02/2019 - 05/2023 **Senior Researcher**, Cultural Trends Laboratory, University of Tyumen, Russia

- Key contributor to the RFBR-funded Digital Humanities project (No. 20-411-720010): authored approximately two-thirds of the grant proposal, shaped the research agenda, led data analysis, and took primary responsibility for research reporting and publications.
- 09/2015 - 02/2019 **Associate Professor**, Department of English Philology and Translation, University of Tyumen, Russia
 - lectures and seminars, thesis supervision for specialist degree, BA and MA students
 - actively supported virtual learning by converting all courses to Moodle, incorporating lecture slides, practical tasks, and testing suites
 - actively contributed to collective initiatives as a voluntary member of the university's self-governing body, supporting community service and institutional development
- 04/2008 **Docent (Associate Professor)**, formally awarded academic title in Linguistics, Federal Service for Supervision in Education and Science, Russian Federation
- 09/2006 - 08/2015 **Associate Professor**, Translation Studies Department, University of Tyumen
 - an active role in establishing BA and MA in Translation degree programmes
 - setting up and supporting the Department website
- 09/2003 - 08/2006 **Lecturer**, English Philology Department, University of Tyumen
 - seminars in theoretical linguistics courses and practical classes

University training and degrees

- 03/2023 **Ph.D** in Computational Linguistics supervised by Prof. Mitkov, Prof. Corpas Pastor, Dr. Le An Ha, University of Wolverhampton, UK. Title: *Translationese indicators for human translation quality estimation*
- 06/2022 **Postgraduate Certificate**: Academic Practice in Higher Education, FHEA Fellow, University of Wolverhampton, UK
- 11/2004 **Candidate of Sciences in Contrastive Linguistics**, Saint Petersburg State University/University of Tyumen, Russia. Title: "Functional potential of light verb constructions in English and Russian"
- 06/2002 **Specialist Degree** in Civil Law (part-time), University of Tyumen, Russia
- 06/1997 **Specialist Degree (with distinction)** in Linguistics, University of Tyumen, Russia

Research leadership and academic projects

- 04/2026–present NLP lead, interdisciplinary RISS project, University of Technology Nuremberg: multilingual political discourse analysis; annotation design and coordination; LLM-based analysis of parliamentary and political texts.
- 2011–2022 Led development of the Russian Learner Translator Corpus (RusLTC), including online error annotation and corpus infrastructure.
- 2022–2024 Collection, processing, annotation and visualisation of big chronological mass-media and social-media data relating to the Russia–Ukraine war (media-monitoring campaign).

Research grants

- 2020–2023 Lead data scientist in the Digital Humanities project *Contemporary Cultural Trends: The Tyumen Region in the Context of Russia and the World*, supported by the Russian Foundation for Basic Research (RFBR), Project No. 20-411-720010.
- 2017–2019 Principal Investigator (PI) of the research project *Linguistic Features of Translated Discourse in Russian: Descriptive Norms and Text Quality Assessment (Based on Newspaper Texts)*, supported by the Russian Foundation for Basic Research (RFBR), Project No. 17-06-00107.
- 2014 Research travel grant from the British Council for a research visit to the University of Leeds.

Academic supervision

Doctoral supervision

- 10/2024–present **Member, Doctoral Thesis Supervision Committee (CET)**, University of Luxembourg. Doctoral candidate: Nils Rehlinger; thesis: *A System for the Automatic Translation of Luxembourgish*. Principal supervisor: Prof. Peter Gilles. Formally appointed 22 October 2024.

Language Science and Technology, Saarbrücken

- 2025 *Giulia Quadri*, Regular Sentence Structure Transformations in German-to-English Human and Machine Translation of Touristic Text
Anastasia Tasioudi, AI vs Commercial and Open-Source Translation Models: A Comparative Analysis of Translation Quality (based on EN-DE translation of a popular-scientific text)
- European Master's in Technologies for Translation and Interpreting (EM TTI)
- 2022 *Kateryna Poltorak*, Register Variation in English-to-Spanish Translation
René Alberto García Taboada, Neutralising Latin American Spanish Dialects for Localisation Purposes: A Multiword Expressions Focus
- 2021 *Marine Ovesyan*, Comparative Evaluation of Generic NMT Systems: Human Judgment and Automatic Metrics
- Before 2019 Supervision of more than 20 Specialist degree (MA) and Bachelor's degree students.

Teaching experience

Independently developed and taught courses

- SS 2025 **Seminar: Quality in Human and Machine Translation (QMHT)**, Saarland University. Independently designed and taught as a semester-long research seminar integrating linguistic and computational approaches to translation quality. Covered theoretical foundations, comparative evaluation of human and machine translation, and manual and automatic quality assessment.
- 2020 - 2022 **Digital Skills for Research, EM TTI (UK and Spain)**, four-week workshop (8 sessions). Designed and taught practical training in LaTeX for academic writing, presentations and bibliographies; reference management with Mendeley and Zotero; and version control and collaboration using Git and GitHub.

Co-taught semester-long courses

- SS 2026 Deep Learning for Digital Humanities / Deep Learning in NLP for Social Sciences (DLDH+SocSci), MA, Goethe University Frankfurt and University of Technology Nuremberg. Co-taught with Prof. Dr. Daniela Grunow.

SS 2025 **BA Abschlussarbeit Kolloquium**, Saarland University. Semester-long course co-taught with Prof. Dr. Anne-Marie Verkerk.

Invited lectures and teaching contributions

WS 2024/25 – HS Empirical Linguistics and Translatology+lab on pre-processing and annotation; – Information Theory course for PhD students): Application of Information Theory in Translation(ese) Studies, – Vorlesung VL Perspektiven der Linguistik, BA Language Science: Translation and Interpreting Studies, Translation Quality and MT

2019 - 2022 Invited sessions in Corpus Linguistics Course, EMTTI

2006 - 2018 Lectures and seminars in Lexicology, Theoretical Grammar, **Discourse Analysis**, Translation Studies, Corpus Linguistics, practical classes: Computer-assisted translation and translation technology, Translation, Source **Text Comprehension and Analysis**

Key Publications

- 2026 Alyukov M., **Kunilovskaya M.**, and Semenov A. Confuse and Normalise: Authoritarian Propaganda in a High-Choice Media Environment during Russia's Invasion of Ukraine. In P. Goode, ed. *Russian Propaganda Today: Challenges, Effectiveness, and Resistance*, in print. University of Michigan press. Author Accepted Manuscript
- 2026 **Kunilovskaya M.** Translationese as a Rational Response to Translation Task Difficulty. In *Proceedings of the Eleventh Conference on Machine Translation (WMT26)*. Budapest, Hungary. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2603.12050>
- 2026 **Kunilovskaya M.**, Gagan Bhatia, Lisa Sophie Albertelli, Yanran Chen, Christian Greisinger, Lotta Kiefer, Christoph Leiter, Subhadeep Roy, Tewodros Achamaleh, Muhammad Arslan Manzoor, Sebastian Pohl, Yufang Hou, and Steffen Eger. Who Annotates in NLP? A Large-scale Assessment of Human Annotation Reporting between 2018 and 2025. In *Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2026)*. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.02255>
- 2026 **Kunilovskaya M.** and Christina Polkläsener. EPIC-EuroParl-UdS: Information-Theoretic Perspectives on Translation and Interpreting. In *Proceedings of the 15th Conference on Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC 2026)*. Palma de Mallorca, Spain, 11–16 May, pp. 6998–7013. <https://doi.org/10.63317/3txs6tgs4wsu>
- 2025 Shushen Manakhimova, **Kunilovskaya M.**, Ekaterina Lapshinova-Koltunski, and Eleftherios Avramidis. Fine-Grained Evaluation of English-Russian MT in 2025: Linguistic Challenges Mirroring Human Translator Training. In *Proceedings of the Tenth Conference on Machine Translation (WMT25)*, pp. 866–877. <https://aclanthology.org/2025.wmt-1.61/>
- 2025 **Kunilovskaya M.**, Zaitova I., Xue W., Stenger I., and Avgustinova T. Predictability of microsyntactic units across Slavic languages: A translation-based study. In *The Joint 25th Nordic Conference on Computational Linguistics and 11th Baltic Conference on Human Language Technologies*, pp.313–322. <https://aclanthology.org/2025.nodalida-1.34.pdf>

- 2025 Polkläsener C. and **Kunilovskaya M.** Euh...why do interpreters hesitate? an information-theoretic perspective on sentence-initial filler particles in simultaneous interpreting. In *12th edition of Disfluency in Spontaneous Speech (DISS 2025), Interspeech workshop*, pp.92–96. <https://doi.org/10.21437/DiSS.2025-19>
- 2024 **Kunilovskaya M.**, Chowdhury K.D., Przybyl H., España i Bonet C., and Van Genabith J. Mitigating Translationese with GPT-4: Strategies and Performance. In *Proceedings of the 25th Annual conference of the European Association for Machine Translation*, pp.411–430. Association for Computational Linguistics, Sheffield, UK. <https://aclanthology.org/2024.eamt-1.35.pdf>
- 2023 Alyukov M., **Kunilovskaya M.**, and Semenov A. (2023). Wartime Media Monitor (WarMM-2022): A Study of Information Manipulation on Russian Social Media during the Russia-Ukraine War. In *Proceedings of the 7th Joint SIGHUM Workshop on Computational Linguistics for Cultural Heritage, Social Sciences, Humanities and Literature*, pp.152–161. Association for Computational Linguistics. <https://doi.org/10.18653/v1/2023.latechclfl-1.17>
- 2023 **Kunilovskaya M.** (2023). Translationese indicators for human translation quality estimation (based on English-to-Russian translation of mass-media texts). PhD Thesis. University of Wolverhampton, UK. <https://wlv.openrepository.com/handle/2436/625250>
- 2023 **Kunilovskaya M.**, Mitkov R., and Wandl-Vogt E. (2023). Cross-lingual Mediation: Readability Effects. In S. Štajner, H. Saggio, M. Shardlow, and F. Alva-Manchego, eds, In *Proceedings of the Workshop on Text Simplification, Accessibility, and Readability (TSAR-2023)*, pp.33–43. INCOMA Ltd., Shoumen, Bulgaria.
- 2023 **Kunilovskaya M.**, Ilyushchenya T., Morgoun, N., and Mitkov R. Source language difficulties in learner translation: Evidence from an error-annotated corpus. *Target*, 35(1), pp.34–62. <https://doi.org/10.1075/target.20189.kun>
- 2022 **Kunilovskaya, M.**, and Kuzmenko, E. Multilingual embeddings for clustering cultural events. In *Analysis of Images, Social Networks and Texts*, Lecture Notes in Computer Science, vol. 13217 (pp. 81–94). Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-16500-9_8
- 2021 **Kunilovskaya M.**, Lapshinova-Koltunski E., and Mitkov R. Translationese in Russian literary texts. In *Proceedings of the 5th Joint SIGHUM Workshop on Computational Linguistics for Cultural Heritage, Social Sciences, Humanities and Literature*, pp.101–112. Association for Computational Linguistics. <https://doi.org/10.18653/v1/2021.latechclfl-1.12>
- 2021 **Kunilovskaya, M.**, and Plum, A. Text preprocessing and its implications in a digital humanities project. In *Proceedings of the Student Research Workshop Associated with RANLP 2021* (pp. 85-93). <https://aclanthology.org/2021.ranlp-srw.13.pdf>
- 2020 **Kunilovskaya M.**, Kutuzov A., and Plum A. Taxonomy enrichment for Russian: Synset classification outperforms linear hyponym-hypernym projections. In *Computational Linguistics and Intellectual Technologies: papers from the Annual conference "Dialogue"*, volume 19(26), pp.459–469. <https://doi.org/10.28995/2075-7182-2020-19-474-484>

- 2019 **Kunilovskaya M.**, Taslimipoor S., and Ilyushchenya T. Functional text representations for building cross-linguistic comparable corpora in English and Russian. In *Proceedings of the 12th Workshop on Building and Using Comparable Corpora (BUCC 2019)*, pp.37–45. https://comparable.limsi.fr/bucc2019/Kunilovskaya_BUCC2019_paper5.pdf
- 2018 Kutuzov A. and **Kunilovskaya M.** Size vs. structure in training corpora for word embedding models: Araneum Russicum maximum and Russian national corpus. In *Proceedings of Analysis of Images, Social Networks and Texts*. Lecture Notes in Computer Science, Springer, vol.10716. pp.47–58. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-73013-4_5
- 2014 Kutuzov A. and **Kunilovskaya M.** Russian Learner Translator Corpus: Design, research potential and applications. In P. Sojka, A. Horák, I. Kopeček, and K. Pala, eds. In *Proceedings of the 17th International Conference Text, Speech and Dialogue*, volume 8655 of Lecture Notes in Computer Science, vol. 8655, pp.315–323. Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-10816-2_39

Full publication list can be found at <https://kunilovskaya.github.io/>

Academic community service

Reviewing

- PC member (annual) COLM, MT Summit, LaTeCH-CLfL, EMNLP, EAMT, COLING, LREC, RANLP, AIST
- EB Member Journal of Natural Language Processing, Cambridge University Press
- journals Digital Translation, Cognitive Linguistics, Ampersand, JoSTrans, Journal of Natural Language Processing, International Journal of Learner Corpus research, Russian Language Journal

Event/Project organisation

- 06/2024 Multilingual Modelling Workshop (MM-WS), University of Saarland
- 2019-2025 biannual RANLP OC, Publication Chair: Supervising submissions, reviewing, decisions in START; generating Proceedings, building conference programme and schedule
- 2019, 2022 EUROPHRAS OC
- 2022, 2024 NETTT OC
- 2021 TRITON OC

Invited talks, research visits, led workshops and shared tasks

- 02/2026 **Invited talk.** Workshop on Prediction in Interpreting, Saarbrücken.
- 2025 **Shared task.** English–Russian Test Suites, WMT 2025.
- 12/2024 **Invited talk.** Language Technology Group, University of Oslo.
- 12/2023 **Invited talk.** Conversations Series, Culture & Computation Lab, University of Luxembourg.
- 01/2020 **Invited talk.** Centre for Translation Studies, University of Leeds.
- 2020 **Shared task.** Quality Estimation (Russian–English), WMT 2020.
- 2020 **Shared task.** Taxonomy Enrichment for the Russian Language, Dialogue Evaluation.

- 07/2019 **Invited tutor.** Third Summer School in Computational Linguistics, Conference on Text Interpretation (ConTIn), University of Tyumen, Russia. Track: *Creating and Using Corpora in Linguistic Research*. 27–28 June and 2–4 July 2019.
- 10–11/2018 **Research visit.** English Translation Science research group, Department of Language Science and Technology, Saarland University; invited by Prof. Dr. Erich Steiner.
- 10/2017 **Research visit.** Language Technology Group (LTG), Department of Informatics, University of Oslo.

Technical skills and languages

Python	Proficient; PyCharm. NumPy, SciPy, scikit-learn, pandas, Stanza, PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, Gensim; LLM prompting and inference pipelines		
Version control	Git/GitHub	Server Access	SSH, SFTP, Vim, Condor, Linux, Docker
Interactive	Jupyter Notebook, Colab	R	basic
Data annotation	Label Studio, brat, QuestionPro, Google Forms (annotation task design, management, IAA)		
Academic writing	LaTeX/Overleaf	References	Mendeley/Zotero
Academic support	START (conference manager), ScholarOne (journal manager)		
Course design	Moodle VLE, MS Teams Class, Canvas		
Languages	Russian (native), English (C2), German (B2)		

Professional development

In-person schools, workshops, courses

- 2023-2025 Five semesters of Allgemein Deutsch at International Study Centre Saar (ISZ Saar) from A2 to B2 + Doktoranten Konversation, Landeskunde, Phonetik
- 04/2024 Workshop *What Does Leadership Involve?*, organised by SFB 1102, Saarland University, 4–5 April 2024 (two-day professional development workshop).
- 09/2023 Summer School on Deep Learning in NLP at RANLP
- 08/2023 Understanding and Modelling Linguistic Variability Summer school, University of Potsdam
- 02/2023 Information Theory course, Saarland University
- 07/2022 NMT Summer School at NeTTT conference
- 06/2021 Teaching Python to Humanities Students (Higher School of Economics, online)
- 02/2020 Nordic winter school in NLP, University of Oslo
- 08/2018 European Summer School in Logic, Language and Information (Sofia, Bulgaria)
- 09/2017 Moscow-Tartu Digital Humanities School “Texts. Nets. Maps”
- 17/2017 Corpus Linguistics Summer School 2017, Birmingham University
- 09/2019 Summer School on Deep Learning in NLP at RANLP

Self-directed online courses

- 2021 Teaching Python to humanities (economics) students (remote, 6 weeks)
- 2017 R Programming (Coursera, Johns Hopkins University)
- 2016 Data Mining / More Data Mining with Weka (Coursera, The University of Waikato)

2014 Programming for Everybody + Using Python to Access Web Data (Coursera, University of Michigan)